which represents the web development layer.

The web layer of the stack is known as ASP.NET Core. It includes libraries for working with HTTP, routing, authentication, and the classes to support the Razor syntax and HTML generation. In addition to Blazor, which I mentioned previously, ASP.NET Core also includes SignalR, a framework for pushing data from the server to connected clients. The simplest example of a use case for SignalR is a chat application.

Alongside SignalR and Blazor sits the ASP.NET Core model-view-controller (MVC) framework, with Razor Pages on top. Razor Pages is a *feature* of the MVC framework, and it supports development of web applications that adhere to the MVC design pattern. To understand what this means, it is necessary to understand the nature of the ASP.NET Core MVC framework.

1.3.1 The ASP.NET Core MVC framework

ASP.NET Core MVC was the original cross-platform web application framework from Microsoft. It is what is known as an *opinionated* framework. The framework designers have opinions about the architectural decisions, conventions, and best practices users of the framework should apply to produce the highest-quality results. Then, the framework designers produce a framework that steers users into adopting those architectural decisions, conventions, and best practices. Developers throughout Microsoft describe this process as helping customers to fall into the “pit of success.”

1.3.2 Model-view-controller

The developers’ main architectural decision behind the MVC framework was to support the development of web applications that implement the MVC pattern—hence, the name of the framework. This decision is because